



PROGRESS REPORT

Benin: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27 · 108 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY ·
INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	A 2031 digital strategy opened drafting in February 2026, beside a 2060 vision and a presidential programme to 2033; the portfolio then changed hands. 2026-02-05 – drafting of a digital strategy to 2031 opened with external facilitation, building on more than 3,000 km of fibre, the population register and more than 250 digital services , set out as a strategic vision the same month . A digital pillar of a 2060 vision was published in February . 2026-03-21 – the presidential programme for 2026 to 2033 commits to a data-localisation law, national supercomputers and a state platform monetising locally produced data, and counts a government artificial-intelligence super app among existing foundations , framed as a technology hub . No budget, sequencing or implementing agency is stated for any of it, and nothing held establishes that the super app exists. 2026-05-27 – the portfolio changed hands and the ministry was renamed for digital transformation and innovation with an explicit artificial-intelligence strategy mandate , created by decree after the April poll returned a new government . The same decree moved the budget programme codes, so any ministry-keyed budget series breaks at that date.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	A national digital public infrastructure roadmap was drafted in July 2026 on a once-only principle, and architecture referentials went to consultation. 2026-07-31 — a national roadmap was drafted with two external institutes to link fragmented government systems around a once-only principle, the state ceasing to ask citizens for documents it issued itself, with the agency framing the hard part as governance and coherence across infrastructure already built , first reported a fortnight earlier . 2026-07-01 — architecture and application-integration referentials were opened to consultation, to end siloed platform-building . Neither existed before. Both are governance instruments over an exchange that has run since 2020 and is carrying tens of millions of requests a month, reported under data exchange. The sequencing is the notable part: the platform came first and the doctrine for using it is being written six years later.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	The 2023 to 2027 national artificial-intelligence and big-data strategy remains in force, with a fresh strategy mandate given to the renamed ministry. The 2023-2027 national artificial-intelligence and big-data strategy is in force and was in force at the start of the window; the country rose from 145th globally to the sub-Saharan top five on an artificial-intelligence readiness index in three years. Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 amends, replaces or reports against it. What did change is around it: the ministry renamed in May 2026 carries an explicit mandate for a national artificial-intelligence strategy , which implies a successor instrument that has not appeared, and the presidential programme's supercomputer and data-monetisation commitments sit outside the existing strategy's scope.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	A data-localisation law is committed in the presidential programme, with no draft, scope or timetable on file. 2026-03-21 — the presidential programme for 2026 to 2033 commits to a data-localisation law . None existed before it and no draft, scope or timetable has followed in the five months since. The commitment sits beside two live positions it would bear on. The generative-artificial-intelligence regime reported under government use already forbids transfer of administration data to extraterritorial jurisdictions by contract, and concedes that contract does not close the risk. And the national data centre reported under storage has no published capacity, so what a localisation duty would be satisfied against is not established.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The 2017 identification law is the statutory base for the identifier and the agency, extended in June 2025 to foreigners and Afro-descendants. The 2017 law is the statutory base for the identification of natural persons, creating the identification agency and the unique personal identifier . It is held as the text layer of a scan, so quotation from it is unsafe. 2025-06-23 – law 2025-12 creates a residents file with distinct foreigner and Afro-descendant identifiers, for migration control and civic inclusion . Nothing of the kind existed before it, and it is the only amendment to the identity statute in the window. The instrument the estate still lacks is a rule on what may be asked of the register: the data protection authority's intervention on the electoral roll, reported under data protection, was a regulator settling by decision a question no statute answers.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	The exchange's founding decree of March 2020 is in force and now on file, acquired as a signed scan rather than a gazette copy. The decree instituting the national exchange was signed on 18 March 2020 and remains in force . What moved in the window is custody rather than law: the base acquired the signed decree in August 2026 from the operator's own media host. It is not a gazette copy, and the file is a page-image scan with no text layer, so its articles cannot be quoted. No amendment, implementing decree or successor statute appears. The instruments that have moved are administrative – the access conditions and the architecture referentials reported elsewhere – which is how a six-year-old decree comes to govern an exchange carrying 32.7m requests a month.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	A four-country comparative study found no artificial-intelligence-specific legislation in force or in draft; the 2023 to 2027 strategy carries the field. 2026-08-10 — a four-country comparative study of West African artificial-intelligence governance found no artificial-intelligence-specific instrument in force or in draft in Benin , and rates a neighbour's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance. That is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one. What carries the field instead is soft law: the national strategy, the data protection authority's artificial-intelligence policy and the generative-tool regime for public agents, all reported elsewhere in this report. Each binds a part of the state and none binds a private deployer, which is the gap a statute would close.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Data protection	Data protection authority	The authority examined 907 files and sanctioned 14 cases in 2025, and required extraneous fields stripped from the electoral roll before publication. 2026-06-25 — the 2025 report records 907 files examined with 87.4% validated, 782 contentious, 64 control missions, 75 conformity certificates, 37 data-protection officers and 14 sanctioned cases . The authority flags its own gaps as the absence of algorithmic-audit tooling and of budget, and it was created by the digital code . 2026-05-16 — it required extraneous fields to be stripped from the electoral roll before publication , resolving a transparency-against-privacy question by regulatory decision rather than by legislation. Its statutory reporting is the weak point. One activity report covering 2015 to 2020 was published under the digital code and nothing later is held, so a duty that is statutory has produced one document in a decade — against an annual compliance report that does exist.	ADVANCED in caseload
Data protection	National data protection readiness		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	Ministers adopted a single digital market declaration at Cotonou, the authority signed cooperation conventions with two neighbours, and the country joined a global identity campaign. 2025-11-19 – West and Central African ministers adopted a declaration committing to 90% affordable broadband by 2030, interoperable identity and payments, doubled intra-African e-commerce, harmonised cyber, data and artificial-intelligence frameworks, and 20m people with basic digital skills . No implementation report against it has followed. 2026-04-17 – the data protection authority signed cooperation conventions with two neighbouring regulators ; its president is vice-president of the francophone association and sits on the African network's executive committee. 2026-06-02 – the country joined the 50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign as its sixteenth African member . All three are commitments rather than instruments. What Benin actually exports is running code: the cross-border identity pilot and the police fingerprint link reported below.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	Free roaming with two neighbours went live in April 2026, and a fingerprint system was wired to the regional police data exchange. 2026-04-24 – community free roaming with Senegal and Togo went live under the regional regulation, with free incoming calls for 30 days , where none existed before. 2025-09-30 – a fingerprint identification system was inaugurated and connected to the regional police data exchange, European Union-funded and implemented through Interpol . The two are the useful shape of regional integration on this ledger: a tariff instrument that reaches subscribers directly, and a biometric link between police forces that reaches them without their knowledge. No data-protection instrument governing the second is on file.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	A cross-border digital identity pilot is running with two other states through the continental exchange, on trust chains and verification-request processing. 2026-08-11 – a cross-border digital identity pilot is running with Rwanda and Ghana through the continental data exchange, working through public-key trust chains, interface contracts, cross-border verification-request processing and incident response, with eighteen more countries said to be joining , following a technical mission earlier in the year . Nothing of the kind existed before. It is the only working cross-border data arrangement on this ledger, and it is a pilot: no transfer volume, no legal basis for the transfers and no published agreement appears. The domestic authorisation route reported under data exchange requires the data protection authority to clear a private body before first connection, and nothing states how that applies to a foreign one.	ADVANCED
Standards	National interoperability standards	The interoperability framework binds public and private bodies providing a public service, on named standards, with its coordinating structure reporting to the President. The framework has been in force since March 2020, binding public and private bodies that provide a public service, with four levels of challenge, five common infrastructure components and named standards . Its governance clause states that the coordinating structure should report directly to the President – an explicit answer to the question of who outranks a ministry that declines to connect. Nothing amended it in the window. The referentials consulted on in July 2026, reported under the interoperability roadmap, are the first attempt to add architecture standards on top of it, and no conformance regime, certification scheme or published register of compliant systems exists.	NO CHANGE
Standards	National quality standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	Adoption of international standards		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	Open government co-creation opened in July 2026 with commune-level consultation, eighteen months after the country joined the partnership. 2026-07-29 – co-creation of the first open government national action plan opened at a Cotonou workshop with commune-level consultation , eighteen months after accession. Nothing existed before it. The eighteen-month gap is the finding: joining was the act, and the plan that gives it content is only now being written. No commitments, no timetable and no civil-society membership of the process is published. The other non-governmental contribution on this ledger is not consultative at all – a non-governmental organisation issuing identity cards, reported under registration of the population, which uncovered failures in the state's own enrolment data by doing the state's work.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	The country ranks fourth in Africa on a 2026 internet-freedom assessment, a reference ranking cited rather than absorbed. 2026-07-11 – a 2026 internet-freedom assessment places the country fourth in Africa . It is a reference ranking, cited and not absorbed, and no prior placing is held, so the base can state the position and not the direction. Nothing else on this ledger touches online expression: no content law, no platform regulation, no shutdown, no prosecution and no consultation on any of the digital instruments listed in this report appears. The one participation mechanism on record is the open government process reported above, which opened a month before the window closed.	NO CHANGE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	The digital budget programme executed 0.62% of credits by 30 April 2026 against 15.43% across all programmes, and the agencies running the estate carry no budget line of their own. 2026-06-22 – the first per-programme execution figures the country has published put the digital programme at 0.62% of credits ordered at 30 April 2026 against 15.43% across all programmes, and 1.32% on the domestically financed portion alone , on a rectifying finance law whose presentation note carries the detail and whose arbitrations covered video protection . The whole of that execution is domestic, because the programme's external loan tranche had drawn nothing, and the ministry's own steering programme ran at 20.12% , so this is programme-specific rather than ministry-wide. The institutional reading is the second half. The data protection authority carries its own line across three volumes while the agency running the response team, the data centre and the public-key infrastructure has no visible line in any of them, and the identity agency carries no programme of its own ; the ministry's own four flagship projects were presented separately . Quarterly execution reporting exists and does not reach this level: reports are published at each quarter-end with a citizen version , and the citizen edition carries no per-programme breakdown .	STALLED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships		NO EVIDENCE
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Development-partner project financing	A US\$137m regional digital programme and a XOF 19.5bn finance-ministry loan were committed, with CAD5m announced for women-led businesses. 2026-03-16 – US\$137m was approved for Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone across infrastructure, business-environment and cross-border pillars, for broadband for more than 5m people and digital public services for more than 5m more . 2026-05-19 – a XOF 19.5bn regional development bank loan, about US\$32.5m, entered implementation to modernise the finance ministry's data centre, the postal operator's information system and two further systems . 2026-08-07 – CAD5m was announced for the digital transformation of women-led businesses, one of seven projects in a package of about CAD17m , carried in the donor's own record , naming no implementing partner, start date or duration. Behind them, a programme-for-results running since 2023 reaches the tax directorate, public payments and public financial management systems . Against all of it, the domestic digital programme's own execution rate, reported under domestic financing, was a fraction of the average across programmes.	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	A second operator launched fifth-generation service in April 2026, two years after the first. 2026-04-28 – a second operator launched fifth-generation service, after the first launched in 2024 . That is the whole of the window's movement in network capability. No subscriber total, penetration rate, coverage footprint or regulator return appears on this ledger for either generation of network, so what is recorded is the arrival of a second competitor and nothing about who is on either network. The regulator's own 2025 report is held for its mobile-money and usage findings, reported elsewhere, and carries no connection figure in the account held.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	Data prices fell from 4,000 to 995 FCFA a gigabyte between 2016 and 2023, and no measurement since is held. Mobile data fell from 4,000 FCFA a gigabyte in 2016 to 995 in 2023 . The series ends three years before the window opens, so the direction of prices across the window is unmeasured. No tariff schedule, basket measure or regulator price return appears anywhere on this ledger, and the second fifth-generation launch reported above came with no published pricing. The regional declaration Benin signed commits to 90% affordable broadband by 2030 without defining affordable, and no baseline against that commitment exists here.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	More than 3,000 km of fibre underpins the service estate, cited as a foundation of the 2031 strategy and unchanged in the window. More than 3,000 km of fibre is cited as underpinning the service estate and as a foundation of the 2031 strategy . The figure is a strategy citation rather than an operator or regulator return, and the same figure stood at the start of the window. No route map, capacity, utilisation or extension programme is published, and no second measurement exists to read it against. The regional financing reported under development-partner project financing carries a broadband pillar, and nothing yet states what of it lands on this backbone.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	The national data centre operates behind the cyber stack with no capacity figure held, and a feasibility study for a redundant second site closed in March 2026. The national data centre is in operation behind the national cyber stack, with no capacity, tier or tenancy figure held — the same position as at the start of the window. 2026-03-27 — submissions closed on a technical, economic and legal feasibility study for a redundant second data centre, tendered under the regional digital integration project, not necessarily sited in Benin, to be completed within six months . The existing site spans 300 square metres. A single unmeasured facility carrying an exchange that moves 32.7m requests a month is the risk the study exists to address, and the study's own six-month deadline falls at the end of September 2026, so nothing on the record yet says what it concluded.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Grid reliability		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems		NO EVIDENCE
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	The security stack has run since 2020 with a response team, public-key infrastructure and forensic laboratory, and a first national vulnerability report published 878 findings. A national digital-security strategy has run since 2020 with a national response team, a national public-key infrastructure, a forensic-analysis laboratory and a critical-infrastructure protection policy, under the Malabo and Budapest conventions . 2025-06-25 – the first national vulnerability report covered 2021 to 2024: 878 recorded vulnerabilities of which 23% critical, 832 password breaches, and institutional compliance ranging from 6% to 87% with the public service worst hit at 326 cases , presented at the annual forum . Publishing it is a deliberate act of transparency that tempers the success narrative. 2026-06 – more than 230 services delivered online are framed by the agency as an expanding exposure, with about 40 priority structures under tailored oversight , while an expert roadmap to 2033 urges a sovereign cloud and a national cyber authority, neither of which exists . Enforcement reaches outward: the country was among those in a regional takedown producing 651 arrests . A vendor telemetry count of 631 ransomware detections in 2024 is the only exposure figure held , on an unpublished denominator.	ADVANCED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	The exchange carried 32.7m requests in 30 days across 73 members and 512 services, and conditions of access were published in July 2026. 2026-07-11 — the operator's public directory records 138,174,337 cumulative requests with 32.7m in the last 30 days, across 73 members, 176 information systems and 512 services, the heaviest providers being land transport, identity and tax . It was already operating at the start of the window; what is new is the scale and the fact that it is published. 2026-07-28 — conditions of access were published: registration in a catalogue of interoperable solutions, demonstrated data governance, compatible infrastructure, a convention per exchange naming data, purposes, responsibilities and security measures, and for a private body an adhesion convention plus data-protection authority authorisation before first connection . That makes the authority a step in the technical onboarding path rather than a post-hoc complaint channel. No fee schedule, processing time or count of authorised participants is stated. 2026-01-27 — a road-enforcement data platform centralising police, transport and road-safety data is being extended for full interoperability with the exchange .	ADVANCED in traffic
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	One presidency-attached agency owns the identity, population, civil and electoral registers as a single integrated system, issuing a card to the regional standard since 2020. A single presidency-attached agency owns identity, the population register, the civil registry and the electoral register as one integrated system, with its director general doubling as National Civil Registrar . The agency frames that as a structural decision rather than a technical one, and it has held since 2017. The card has been issued to the regional biometric standard since 2020 and remains so. Neither moved in the window, which is the point: the architecture is settled and what changed sits on top of it — issuance volumes, cross-border pilots and the services drawing on the register. The concentration is also the standing risk, and no source on this ledger records an independent audit, an oversight board or an appeal route against the agency.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	Biometric enrolment stands at about 98-99% with 7.7m identification numbers issued, while a charity issued 130,000 free cards and found dead enrolment numbers. The 2017 identification law created the agency and a unique personal identifier reaching about 10m people in six months ; a World Bank-supported programme added 2.2m more, lifting biometric enrolment to about 98-99%, with 7.7m personal identification numbers and 6.1m certificates issued free , the system being described as increasing access to services . The gap between enrolment and a card in hand is what the window exposed. 2026-05-18 — a non-governmental organisation issued more than 130,000 free cards across nine communes in eight months on an electoral-participation rationale , and in doing so found failed fingerprints and dead enrolment numbers left by the earlier campaign . So near-universal enrolment and incomplete issuance sit together, and the defect was surfaced by a charity doing the state's distribution rather than by the agency's own reporting.	ADVANCED in issuance rather than in coverage
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	The national root certification authority and trust services entered operation on 1 July 2026, having been established a year earlier without operating. The national root certification authority and its trust services were established in July 2025 and not yet operating ; 2026-07-01 — they are recorded as operating . That closes a twelve-month gap between an instrument and a service, and it is the trust layer under the exchange, the diaspora passport platform and the certificate issuance reported elsewhere in this report. No certificate volume, accredited provider list or evidential rule is published, so what a signature issued under it is worth in a Beninese court is not established on this record.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	Identity is required for SIM registration and now carries diaspora passport renewal in more than 80 countries. 2025-04-30 – unregistered SIM cards were deactivated under a regulator order , an anti-fraud measure that reporting itself noted demands a strong data-protection frame. The position is unchanged since. 2025-10-24 – a diaspora biometric passport renewal platform went live, available in more than 80 countries with renewals reported at about 15 minutes , built by an external vendor on the national exchange and tied to national identity and immigration systems . The register's reach is the country's distinguishing feature and is measured under the population register below. What is missing across both cases is any published rule on which body may query identity for what purpose: the access conventions reported under data exchange are the nearest thing, and they govern connection rather than use.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The regional central bank digital currency is in pilot, against a domestic debate on crypto-asset opportunity and risk. 2026-04-29 – the regional electronic currency is in pilot, alongside a domestic debate on crypto-asset opportunity and risk . No baseline preceded it on this ledger. Monetary and payments governance for Benin is regional rather than national: the instant payment rail, the currency pilot and the union-wide account statistics all sit with the regional central bank, and no domestic instrument, supervisory statement or scheme rule appears on this ledger. The one national payments intervention in the window came from a consumer-redress body, reported under consumer protection.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	A productive safety net began cash transfers in September 2025 to 20,621 beneficiaries, 85% of them women, onto free secured SIM cards. 2025-09-18 – cash transfers began to 20,621 beneficiaries, 85% of them women, paid a first monthly instalment of 208,272,100 FCFA across twelve pilot communes onto free secured SIM cards, ahead of an intended extension to all 77 communes . Eligibility was certified house by house by the statistics institute and the social affairs ministry. Nothing existed before it and no extension beyond the twelve pilot communes has been reported in the eleven months since. The house-by-house certification is the interesting detail: the targeting was done on foot, and the single social register created four months later, reported under registries, is the instrument intended to replace that method.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	A 1% levy on large cash payments pushes merchants onto digital rails, joined by the 2026 rectifying law's digital taxes and cashless motorway tolls. A 1% levy on large cash payments has been in force since January 2025, with mobile money the route around it , and 2026-06-11 — the rectifying finance law added digital taxes . 2026-03-19 — cashless motorway tolling went live , where none existed. Taken together these are fiscal instruments doing digital-inclusion work: the state is taxing cash and removing it from a tolled network rather than subsidising the alternative. No revenue figure, adoption rate or effect on cash use is published for either measure, and the tax directorate's own system modernisation, reported under sectoral systems, has published no delivery.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	The regional instant payment rail launched across all eight member states in September 2025, free domestically, with banks and mobile money fully interconnected by May 2026. 2025-09-30 — the regional instant payment rail launched across all eight member states, free for domestic transfers, with banks and mobile money fully interconnected by May 2026 , against a rail that had only just launched at the start of the window. Free and fully interconnected is as complete as any payment position on this ledger gets. What is not published is use: no transaction count, value or Benin-specific participation figure appears, so the rail's reach is asserted by its architecture rather than measured. The domestic layer riding on it is a home-grown aggregator, reported under national production capacity.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Mobile money reached 88.09% penetration on 11.65m active accounts, one operator holding about 51% of accounts and 83% of revenue. 2026-05-19 — the regulator's 2025 report puts mobile money at 88.09% penetration on 11.65m active accounts at end-2025, with one operator holding about 51% of accounts and about 83% of revenue , against 248.7m electronic-money accounts across the union in 2024 . The revenue share is the finding. A market where half the accounts produce four fifths of the revenue is not a competitive one, and nothing on this ledger records a regulatory response, an interconnection remedy or a price intervention. Uptake at this level makes mobile money the effective account layer for the population, which is what the cash levy and the toll and transfer programmes reported elsewhere all assume.	ADVANCED in accounts, with concentration unchanged
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	A financial-sector consumer redress body was stood up in July 2025 against unresolved complaints about failed mobile-money transactions. 2025-07-29 — a financial-sector consumer redress body was established, against complaints about failed mobile-money transactions going unresolved . None existed before it. No caseload, resolution rate or decision from it has been published in the thirteen months since, so the body exists and its effect does not appear on the record. That matters against a market of 11.65m active accounts in which one operator holds most of the revenue, reported under uptake: the redress route is the only counterweight on this ledger to a concentration the regulator has not otherwise acted on.	ADVANCED
Registries	Population register	The register connects more than 80 institutions at about 200,000 biometric authentications a day, with 25m know-your-customer verifications in 2025. 2026-02-02 — the national register of natural persons connects more than 80 institutions at about 200,000 biometric authentications a day, and in 2025 at least 75% of identification services went digital, across 10.5m services and 25m electronic know-your-customer verifications , reported alongside mass adoption of the digital identity . It was already operating at the start of the window, so what moved is volume, and the volume is the largest of any system on this ledger. Nothing published states the error rate, the failed-authentication rate or what happens to a person the register cannot match — which is the question the failed fingerprints found during the charity card campaign, reported under registration of the population, put directly.	ADVANCED in volume

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Civil register	A single-window pilot at ten maternities lifted birth registration to 76.56% against about 22% nationally, and generalisation slipped three to four months. Behind near-universal biometric coverage sits a weak civil-registration leg: about 2.5m births were declared between 2021 and 2025 against under 1m actually registered, because parents had to make a second trip . 2026-07-16 — a single-window pilot at ten maternities lifted registration to 76.56%, against about 22% nationally in 2025 . 2026-02-26 — the six-month review recorded generalisation slipping three to four months into a consolidation phase . This is the sharpest finding in the country's identity estate. A register authenticating about 200,000 times a day is fed by a civil registration process capturing roughly a fifth of births nationally, and the fix works where it has been tried and has not been extended.	ADVANCED in the pilot rather than in generalisation
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Business register	Business registration runs online as the formalisation route for the informal sector, with no registration total published; a regional credit bureau reports union-wide figures only. The business registration platform registers economic units online from desktop and mobile, as the formalisation route for the informal sector . The account held is a 2021 case study and carries no registration total; nothing later is on file, so the position is unchanged and unmeasured. 2026-08-13 — beside it, the regional credit information bureau operates across all eight union states with 321 data providers, about 48 million contracts and more than 20 million active borrowers, and at its first Cotonou data forum the finance ministry framed data quality as the route to cutting credit-approval turnaround to 48 hours . Those figures are the operator's own and union-wide: no Benin coverage, dispute or data-protection statement is held.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Social protection register	A single social register was created in January 2026 to decide eligibility across programmes from one secured socio-economic database. 2026-01-21 – the Council of Ministers created an information system registering households and deciding eligibility across social-protection programmes, classifying them as non-poor, non-extreme poor and extreme poor and updated periodically, so that cash and in-kind transfers, health insurance, training, credit and pension schemes draw on one secured socio-economic database . The two social-protection programmes already running are named among its users. Nothing existed before it. No enrolment figure, no data-protection assessment, no retention rule and no appeal route against a poverty classification is published – and a classification that gates health insurance and credit is the most consequential automated decision on this ledger.	ADVANCED
Registries	Electoral register	The population register compiled and managed the roll for the April 2026 presidential poll, with regional observer missions satisfied on preparedness. The register is the single source of electoral data under the 2017 law, and platforms to modernise the electoral process were presented in August 2025 , untested at a presidential poll. 2026-04-12 – the agency compiled and managed the list for the presidential poll, and regional and continental observer missions assessed its preparedness and pronounced themselves satisfied . Card fees were waived, with web, mobile, unstructured-menu and photo-update channels open to polling morning . It is the clearest test any system on this ledger has been put to, and it passed on the observers' assessment. The one published intervention against it came from the data protection authority, which required extraneous fields stripped from the roll before publication, reported under data protection.	ADVANCED
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	The national cadastre records 445,695 parcels with the registration certificate mandatory for any transaction, and a land governance programme finalised its operations manual. 2026-03-26 – 445,695 parcels are registered nationally and a decree makes the cadastre registration certificate mandatory for any transaction, legalising sales without a full title but only through the platform , against 491,420 parcels across twelve communes in February 2025 . The two figures are not comparable and the base does not net them: the earlier is a commune-level count and the later a national one. What is unambiguous is the legal change — the platform is now the only lawful route to a transaction, which converts a registry into a gate. 2025-10-17 – a national land governance programme finalised its operations manual, run by the land agency with World Bank support , sitting alongside the cadastre platform rather than replacing it.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Health	Ministry health reporting runs on a district information system, with private facilities trained into the reporting chain from 2023. The health management information system carries ministry reporting, and private health facilities were trained from 2023 to submit reproductive, maternal, newborn and child health data that had gone largely unreported ; 752 private facilities sat outside the reporting chain before that training. Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 reports on it: no data-quality measure, no completeness rate and no extension. The only health movement in the window is the malaria programme reported under artificial intelligence in sectoral systems, which is a separate analytical layer rather than a change to this one.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Education	The school management system was made complete-data mandatory by ministerial order in February 2026, heads of non-compliant schools barred from examination work. 2026-02-19 – a ministerial order required complete registration of intermediate classes by 23 February 2026, with heads of non-compliant schools barred from the primary certificate examination workforce . The order records that many schools had used the system, three years in place across nursery and primary, only for final-year examination entries. That is the useful detail: a system counted as deployed was in practice an examination-entry tool, and the ministry moved on it with a sanction rather than with support. No compliance rate after the deadline, no record count and no data-quality measure has been published since.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	The social protection scheme's health-insurance strand was generalised beyond its pilot communes in 2021, enrolling against the national identification register. The health-insurance strand moved out of its seven pilot communes into a generalisation phase covering fourteen more, enrolling against the national identification register ; the pilot strand had run since July 2019. Nothing in the window reports on it: no enrolment total, no claims figure and no coverage rate. What changed around it is the targeting layer — the single social register created in January 2026, reported under registries, names the running programmes among its users — so eligibility for this scheme will in future be decided by a database whose governance is not published.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	A justice digitalisation plan for 2026 to 2033 was published in July 2026, committing to a citizen case-tracking portal with no budget or sequencing. 2026-07-24 — the plan commits to a citizen portal for case tracking, secure public hosting of judicial, notarial and bailiff instruments, digitally integrated legal aid and an heir identification mechanism . Nothing existed before it. Two things are worth separating from the reporting around it. The primary contains no court registry system, no direct court-police-prison data link, no blockchain authentication and no judicial security operations centre, contrary to secondary accounts. And no budget, sequencing or implementing agency is stated — the same absence as the presidential programme it sits under .	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	A EUR 2m donor project is modernising the tax directorate's information systems to 31 December 2026, with no delivery published four months from its end date. 2026-08-20 — a project fiche republished for the digital transformation of the tax directorate's information systems records a EUR 2m donor-funded project running from 9 August 2023 to 31 December 2026 , financed under a development agency agreement . It is a fiche rather than a progress report: no delivery, module or completion status is published four months before the stated end date. The directorate's own strategic orientation plan for 2023 to 2027 is the instrument behind the work , and the base had held it only from the financing side until now. Tax is among the three heaviest providers on the national exchange, so the system being modernised is already load-bearing.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	An electronic international waybill went live at the port in May 2026, and three customs administrations agreed a border-modernisation committee. 2026-05-22 – an electronic international waybill launched at the Port of Cotonou, mandatory after a three-month transition , where none existed. 2026-07-27 – the Nigerian, Cameroonian and Beninese customs administrations adopted a communique establishing a trilateral steering committee to implement a benchmarked border-modernisation model on two corridors , signed after a benchmarking mission, with two private firms on the technical team. The platform underneath is unchanged: 44 of 49 customs offices had migrated off the previous system, with more than 30bn CFA collected . The five offices outstanding have not been reported closed, and no clearance-time or volume series is published against any of it.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	More than 230 services run through the national portal, while the e-procurement platform was retired and its build tender failed. 2026-06-25 – more than 230 services are delivered online through a single portal riding on the national exchange , against fewer at the start of the window, and more than 250 digital services are cited in the 2031 strategy material . The country was ranked a 2025 GovTech Maturity Index top performer , a reference index cited and not absorbed. Against that, 2025-09-16 – the first tender to build a new e-procurement platform was declared unsuccessful , after a decree had already retired the previous system and portal for a replacement costed at 3.3bn FCFA on World Bank financing . The old platform is gone and the new one is not built. 2026-07-24 – a joint circular requires every state structure to move archive and procedure management onto digital tools , with returns stated as fiscal and environmental rather than as service improvement, and no deadline, budget, scope definition or compliance mechanism. 2026-07-31 – one university made its academic records platform the sole channel for certificates and transcripts , with no fee schedule, turnaround or appeal route published.	MIXED the service portal grew past 230 services while the procurement platform was retired before its replacement could be built

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government		NO EVIDENCE
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	A generative-artificial-intelligence compliance regime for public agents came into force on 1 June 2026, starting from an admission that agents already used such tools outside any framework. 2026-06-01 — the regime starts from an admission that public agents already use generative tools on personal accounts outside any framework, and orders a census of those users and migration to secured arrangements, a binding harmonised charter, and provider contracts carrying clauses forbidding any use of administration data to train or optimise models, reversibility and a prohibition on transfer to extraterritorial jurisdictions , set out as the framework for artificial intelligence in the administration . It then concedes what most such instruments do not: contractual terms do not close the sovereignty risk, because the model, the infrastructure and the jurisdiction remain another party's. No census result, charter text or contract list has been published since. The candour is the notable part — a state instrument that names its own limit is rare on this ledger.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	An artificial-intelligence, drone and geospatial malaria programme reports incidence down 38% and mortality down 39% across 2022 to 2024, on US\$2.3m of foreign financing. 2026-07-03 – a US\$2.3m programme with Japanese financing combining artificial intelligence, drones and geospatial mapping reports malaria incidence down 38% and mortality down 39% across 2022 to 2024 . Nothing of the kind existed before it on this ledger. The attribution is the caution: the outcome figures cover a period beginning before the programme is dated and no source separates its contribution from the rest of the malaria response. What is established is that an analytical layer is operating over health geography, and that it sits beside a health information system, reported under health, that has published no data-quality measure of its own.	ADVANCED
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	The first voice-to-voice artificial intelligence in Fon launched across three countries, and a strategy co-author published a frugal-artificial-intelligence argument. 2025-06-30 – the first voice-to-voice artificial intelligence in Fon launched, built for mother-tongue service access with philanthropic and regional partners across Benin, Senegal and Côte d'Ivoire . It is the inclusion mechanism the rest of the francophone material on this ledger lacks: every other service reported here assumes literacy in French. 2026-07-29 – a co-author of the national strategy published a book on building a language model from scratch, arguing for frugal domestic artificial intelligence, with a scarcity of processors as the route to it becoming a luxury good as the sharpest claim . No usage figure, funding or institutional home is published for either. Against them, the presidential programme commits to national supercomputers with no budget or sequencing.	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse	The data protection authority adopted a dedicated artificial-intelligence policy with strict purpose limitation, and a six-country francophone governance framework is in development. 2026-05-16 – the authority adopted a dedicated artificial-intelligence policy with strict purpose limitation, one of the few African data-protection authorities to hold one . Nothing preceded it. 2026-07-09 – a six-country francophone artificial-intelligence governance framework is in development with Benin co-leading, and was taken to the United Nations global dialogue . Neither is binding law. The authority's own report names the absence of algorithmic-audit tooling and of budget as its gaps, so a purpose-limitation policy exists without the means to test compliance with it – and no dedicated artificial-intelligence legislation is in force or in draft, reported under legislation.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	A home-grown payment aggregator carries more than 13,000 merchants, and a domestic platform checks text, images, audio and video for manipulation. 2026-05-19 – a domestic payment aggregator carries more than 13,000 merchants on a home-grown rail – a rare Beninese-owned layer in a regionally supplied stack. 2026-07-27 – a content-verification platform founded in 2025 checks text, images, audio and video, including material generated by artificial intelligence . Both are small and both are locally built, which is the point: almost everything else on this ledger of scale is a regional rail, a foreign vendor's platform or a donor-financed programme. Neither publishes revenue, headcount or user figures, so the sector's size is not measurable from this record.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	The skills hub network continues with a university partnership, a francophone digital-skills programme and an annual digital week. The hub network operates with a Sorbonne partnership and online hubs, alongside a francophone digital-skills programme and an annual digital week , the skills programme having been reported in October 2025 . It was operating at the start of the window and nothing reports a change. No cohort size, graduate count, funding figure or company formation is published, so a hub network that is the country's flagship innovation asset produces no measurable output on this record. The two domestic firms named on this ledger, reported under production capacity, are not stated to have come through it.	NO CHANGE
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	About 85 security officers have been certified against a target of 100 by end-2026, and 300 police unit heads were trained in 2026. 2026-08-03 – a cohort of 25 opened, bringing about 85 officers trained against a target of 100 qualified information-security officers by end-2026, on recognised certifications with practical work at the national cyber range, with intake opened beyond central government to local authorities, state enterprises and the private sector . The figures are the agency's own and are not independently verified. Beside it, 300 police unit heads were trained in 2026 , within a programme that also runs a cybersecurity-only incubator and hosts the continental cyber forum , with a statewide risk-management framework and a crisis exercise for state information-security officers. It is the only civil-service capability programme on this ledger with numbers attached, and it is entirely about security rather than about general digital skills.	ADVANCED
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	A city artificial-intelligence academy opened for 60 public-secondary pupils in August 2026, and a first national artificial-intelligence olympiad was held. 2026-08-19 – a city-government track in artificial intelligence, robotics and digital fabrication opened for pupils of the city's public secondary schools, as a ten-day campus for a first cohort of 60 and the first stage of a four-year programme . It is a municipal programme; no budget, curriculum or progression route beyond the first cohort is published. 2026-07-09 – a first national artificial-intelligence olympiad was held . Both are new and both are small. Nothing on this ledger records a national curriculum change, a teacher-training programme or school connectivity, so secondary provision is one city's cohort of sixty and a competition.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	Tele-teaching was authorised across four public universities for 2026-27, beside a science and technology university at Abomey. 2026-07-02 – the Council of Ministers authorised a national tele-teaching platform across four public universities for the 2026-27 year, with virtual amphitheatres for hinterland students , reported as a national e-learning programme . It is authorised and not built. A national science and technology university at Abomey trains in science, technology, engineering and mathematics across more than nine constituent entities , on a standing institutional description that carries no date of its own. No enrolment, graduate count or programme in a digital discipline is published for either, so provision is established and output is not.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy		NO EVIDENCE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs		NO EVIDENCE
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	At least 75% of identification services were accessed digitally in 2025, while the regulator's usage report carries no disaggregation by gender or rurality. 2026-02-02 – at least 75% of identification services were accessed digitally in 2025 , with the unconnected served by an unstructured-menu channel and by in-person windows. That is the clearest adoption figure on this ledger and it is about one service family. 2026-05-19 – the regulator's 2025 report records rising digital usage alongside the mobile-money figures , with no disaggregation by gender or rurality in the account held. So use is rising and nobody has published who is left out. The one intervention that reached the excluded directly was a charity's card distribution, reported under registration of the population, and it worked because it went to nine communes in person.	ADVANCED with the divide itself unmeasured

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The statistics office is named among four being displaced as primary data producers by platform, satellite and privately held data. 2026-03-11 — the national statistics office is named among four case studies of offices being displaced as primary data producers by platform, satellite and privately held data, with the report recommending legal reform to formalise the custodian role . No such reform has followed, and no statistics law, national statistical strategy, census or survey appears anywhere on this ledger for the country. Meanwhile the administrative systems this report tracks — the population register, the cadastre, the school system, the customs platform — are producing counts in volume, and the office that would turn them into official statistics has no stated relationship to any of them.	NO CHANGE
Open data	Use of open data	The exchange operator publishes its own request volumes, members and services, and budget transparency scores 77 out of 100, fifth globally. 2026-07-11 — a public directory publishes the exchange's request volumes, members, information systems and services , a rare instance of an African exchange publishing its own usage. Nothing of the kind existed before it, and it is the reason this report can state the traffic figures it does. 2026-06-19 — the 2025 open budget survey scores the country 77 out of 100 on transparency, fifth globally and second in sub-Saharan Africa, with 52 on participation and 72 on oversight, from 1 out of 100 in 2012 . It is a reference survey, cited and not absorbed. What is absent is a general open data instrument: no policy, no portal, no licence and no dataset inventory appears. Publication here is a practice of two institutions rather than a rule.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Government AI super app	Any statement, screenshot, service listing or usage figure establishing that the 'Super App IA Gouvernementale' counted among the presidential programme's existing foundations exists, is deployed or is used.	2026-08-04
India digital cooperation	A bilateral MoU, DPI cooperation programme document or ministerial readout naming a Benin-India digital instrument.	2026-08-04
Annual performance reports required by the organic budget law	A Rapport annuel de performance for any gestion; none has ever been published, so no full-year executed figure exists for any Benin digital programme.	2026-08-04
Audited figures for any digital budget line	A Cour des comptes rapport sur l'exécution des lois de finances after 2023, or the published text of loi n° 2026-06 settling gestion 2024.	2026-08-04
Dedicated AI legislation	A bill, decree or law regulating artificial intelligence specifically, or an official statement that one is in preparation.	2026-08-10

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